SECTION 0 · UX RESEARCH

UX Research: Mobile Banking

What 260 Thai banking customers told us about moving money on their phone, and how each insight shaped the NAVA design.

12	240	8	5
interviews	survey replies	usability tests	apps reviewed

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. Why do people still visit branches or call the bank?
2. What makes a transfer feel risky, and when do people double-check?
3. Which daily tasks take too many taps in current banking apps?
4. How do older and less confident users get help when stuck?

METHODS

In-depth interviews
12 people · 45 min each
Bangkok, Chiang Mai, Khon Kaen. Ages 22–70, mixed income and tech confidence.

Online survey
240 replies · 18 questions
Usage frequency, top tasks, trust and security concerns, feature priorities.

Competitive review
5 Thai banking apps
Walk-through of log in, transfer, QR pay, bills and card controls. Taps and clarity counted.

Usability testing
8 people · clickable prototype
6 core tasks on the NAVA prototype: success rate, time on task and SUS score.

SURVEY FINDINGS

n = 240

- **82%** check their balance at least once a day
- **74%** pay with QR at least once a week
- **63%** worry about sending money to the wrong account
- **51%** could not find bill payment within 10 seconds
- **46%** dropped out of online account opening at least once
- **38%** of users over 55 call the bank for help with the app

Amber = pain points the design must solve

AFFINITY MAP · INTERVIEW QUOTES

96 notes → 4 themes

Fear of mistakes	Too many steps	Hard to get help	Onboarding pain
"I read the account number three times before I press send."	"Paying the electricity bill takes me eight taps."	"When my card was lost I had to call and wait 20 minutes."	"The ID photo failed four times."
"If the name doesn't show, I don't transfer."	"Menus are hidden in a menu inside a menu."	"I never know if my problem is being handled."	"I gave up and went to the branch."
"Large amounts make my hands sweat."	"I just want to see my balance, not ads."	"My son sets up everything for me."	"Why do I need so many passwords?"

INSIGHT		DESIGN RESPONSE	SCREEN
People trust a transfer only after they see the receiver's real name.	→	**Show the verified name before the amount, then a separate review step.**	UI 11 · 13
Bills feel scattered across many menus.	→	**One Pay Bills hub with due dates, reminders and auto-pay.**	UI 18 · 19
Opening an account online fails at the ID and face step.	→	**3-step e-KYC with live framing tips and clear progress.**	UI 03 · 04
Large transfers cause anxiety and fraud fear.	→	**Face verification for ฿50,000+ with the amount and receiver always visible.**	UI 14
Losing a card means a long phone call.	→	**Freeze or block a card in two taps and track the replacement as a case.**	UI 24 · 30
Users can't find features they rarely use.	→	**Universal search for people, bills and settings, plus recents.**	UI 10

PROTOTYPE USABILITY TEST

n = 8

Task	Success	Avg time
Send ฿500 to a saved contact	100%	24 s
Pay an electricity bill	100%	31 s
Scan a QR at a shop	100%	12 s
Freeze a lost card	88%	19 s
Find last month's spending	88%	27 s
Open account (e-KYC)	75%	3 m 40 s

84 SUS score · "Excellent"
Next round: retest e-KYC after fixes

Figures are sample study data for this design case study, not published market statistics.

SECTION 0 · PERSONAS

Personas: who NAVA is for

Three primary personas built from the interviews and survey clusters. Every key screen is checked against at least one of them.

PW Ploy Wongsawat, 27

Marketing executive · Bangkok
The quick payer

"I pay for everything with QR. If the app takes more than three taps, I get annoyed."

Lives in a condo near the BTS, earns about ฿42,000 a month. Splits bills with friends, shops online and pays for coffee and taxis by QR every day.

GOALS
- Pay and transfer in seconds, one-handed
- See where her money went this month
- Save for a trip to Japan next year

FRUSTRATIONS
- Ads and pop-ups before she can see her balance
- Bill payment hidden deep in the menu
- Typing account numbers for friends

WHAT MATTERS MOST

Speed	95
Security	60
Control of spending	75
Rewards	70

TECH CONFIDENCE
92 / 100
Apps used daily: LINE · Shopee · Grab · Instagram

SCENARIO
At lunch she scans the café QR, then sends her share of dinner to a friend from Send again on Home.

Designed for them in UI 08 Home · 16 Scan QR · 21 Wallet · 10 Search

SC Somsak Chaiyaporn, 48

Noodle shop owner · Chiang Mai
The busy merchant

"Customers pay by QR all day. I need to know the money arrived, right away."

Runs a family noodle shop with his wife. Receives 80–120 QR payments a day, pays suppliers weekly and keeps business and family money in separate accounts.

GOALS
- Confirm each incoming payment instantly
- Pay suppliers in bulk without mistakes
- Keep shop and home money apart

FRUSTRATIONS
- Small text and crowded screens in a busy shop
- Fear of sending a large supplier payment to the wrong account
- No clear daily total of sales

WHAT MATTERS MOST

Speed	85
Security	80
Control of spending	65
Rewards	30

TECH CONFIDENCE
58 / 100
Apps used daily: LINE · Facebook · YouTube · Food delivery

SCENARIO
On Friday he sends ฿75,000 to his supplier. NAVA shows the verified name, asks for a face scan and gives him an e-Slip to forward on LINE.

Designed for them in UI 11 Transfer · 13 Review · 14 Face check · 22 History

MS Malee Srisuk, 66

Retired teacher · Khon Kaen
The careful saver

"I am afraid of pressing the wrong button and losing my savings to a scammer."

Lives with her daughter's family. Gets a monthly pension, pays the electricity and water bills, and sends money to her grandson at university.

GOALS
- Pay household bills on time without help
- Feel sure that her money is safe
- Reach a real person quickly when something goes wrong

FRUSTRATIONS
- Scam calls and SMS that look like the bank
- Losing her place in long sign-up forms
- Not knowing if a problem is being handled

WHAT MATTERS MOST

Speed	30
Security	98
Control of spending	70
Rewards	20

TECH CONFIDENCE
34 / 100
Apps used daily: LINE · YouTube · Facebook

SCENARIO
A reminder says the electricity bill is due in 3 days. She opens it, checks the amount against last month, turns on auto-pay and taps Pay.

Designed for them in UI 18 Pay Bills · 19 Bill details · 24 Lost card · 30 Help & cases

Customer Journey Map · NAVA Mobile Banking

From first hearing about the app, through onboarding and daily use, to getting help when something goes wrong.

PERSONA (EXAMPLE)
PS Pimchanok "Pim", 29
Marketing exec · Bangkok · 6+ hrs/day on mobile

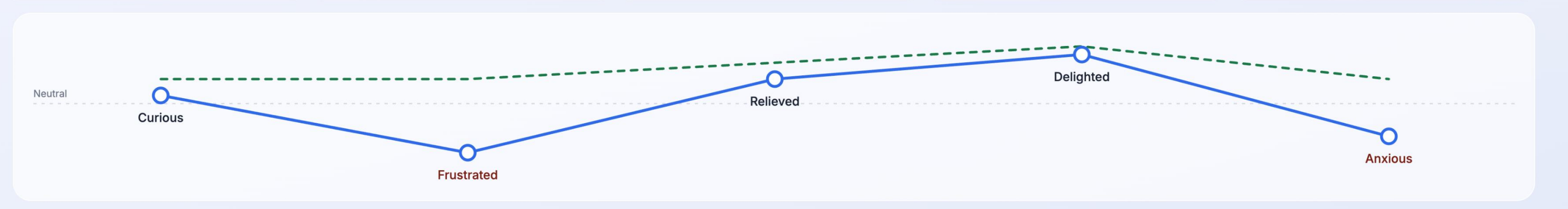
Goals
Handle all banking from her phone without visiting a branch, and see where her money goes each month.

Frustrations
Fear of sending money to the wrong person; long identity checks that fail without explanation.

Expectations
Fast, simple and secure, with instant access to a real person when something goes wrong.

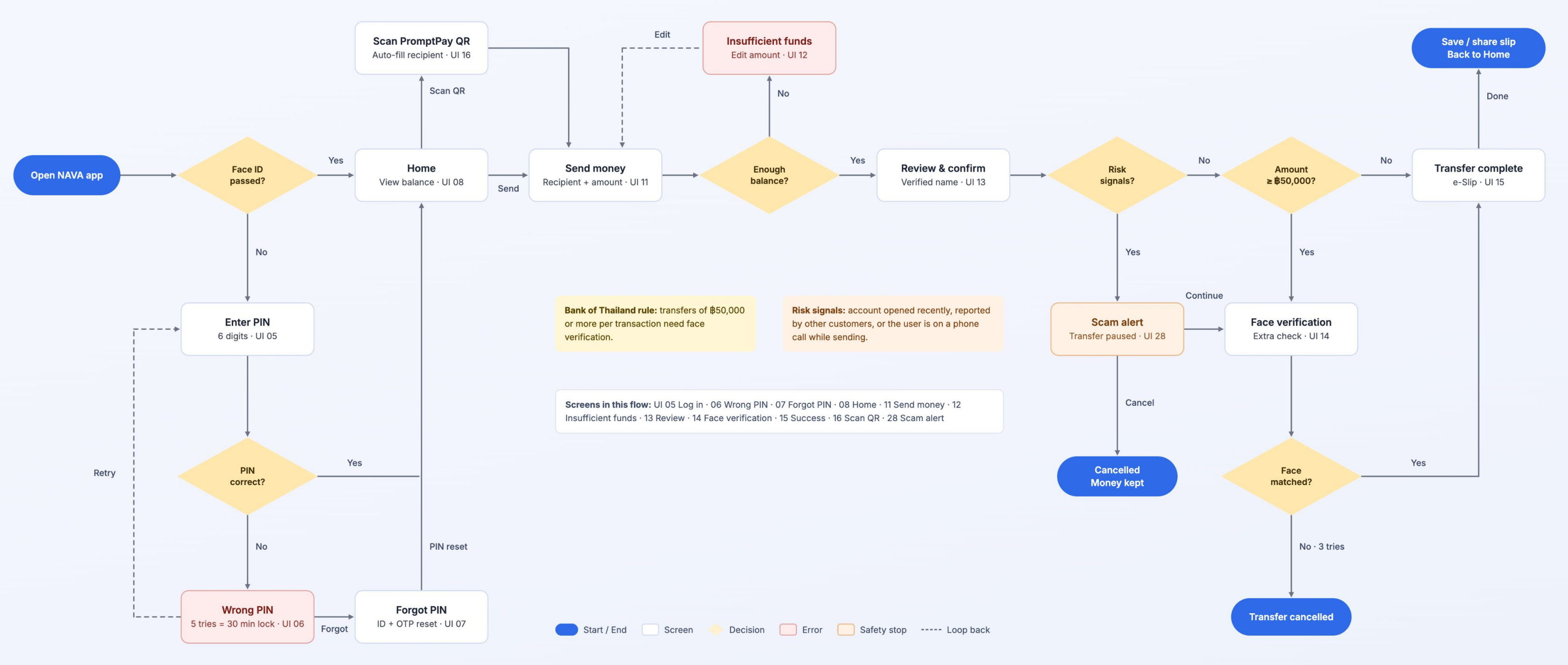
	Stage 1 **Discover** Ads, reviews, word of mouth	Stage 2 **Onboard** Download + e-KYC	Stage 3 **First Use** Set PIN + first transfer	Stage 4 **Everyday Banking** Scan to pay, bills, balance	Stage 5 **Support & Loyalty** Resolve issues, recommend
Actions What she does	Sees a social ad, reads reviews, compares fees with her current bank.	Downloads the app, photographs her ID card, completes a face scan and fills in personal details.	Sets a PIN and Face ID, tops up the account, sends money to a friend via PromptPay.	Scans QR codes at shops, pays electricity and phone bills, sets a savings goal.	Hits a pending or mistaken transfer, contacts in-app chat or the call center until it's fixed.
Touchpoints Where it happens	Social media Bank website Friends	App Store / Play Store e-KYC flow SMS OTP	NAVA app Push notifications e-Slip	NAVA app Merchant QR Home-screen widget	In-app chat Call center Branch
Thoughts What she's thinking	"Can I really open an account online without going to a branch?"	"The ID photo failed again, and it won't tell me why."	"Easier than I expected, but I'm still scared of sending it to the wrong person."	"Scan-to-pay is so quick. I use it every day."	"I've been on hold forever. Where is my case at?"
Pain Points What goes wrong	Fees and benefits are scattered across pages, hard to compare.	ID photo and face scan fail with no reason given; leaving mid-way means starting over.	Unsure the recipient is correct; security setup has too many steps.	App slows down at month-end; too many notifications feel like spam.	No way to track a case; has to repeat the story every time she calls.
Opportunities How we improve	A clear fee-comparison page and a refer-a-friend link with rewards.	Live camera guidance ("move closer", "reduce glare") and saved progress to resume later.	Always show the recipient's name before confirming; favourites; 3-step onboarding.	Quick actions on the login screen, monthly spending summary, notification controls.	In-app case tracker, with context passed to agents automatically.

Emotions
How she feels



User Flow: Money Transfer in NAVA

From opening the app to the e-Slip, with log-in recovery, low balance, scam check and the ฿50,000 face check. Every screen is tagged with its UI number.



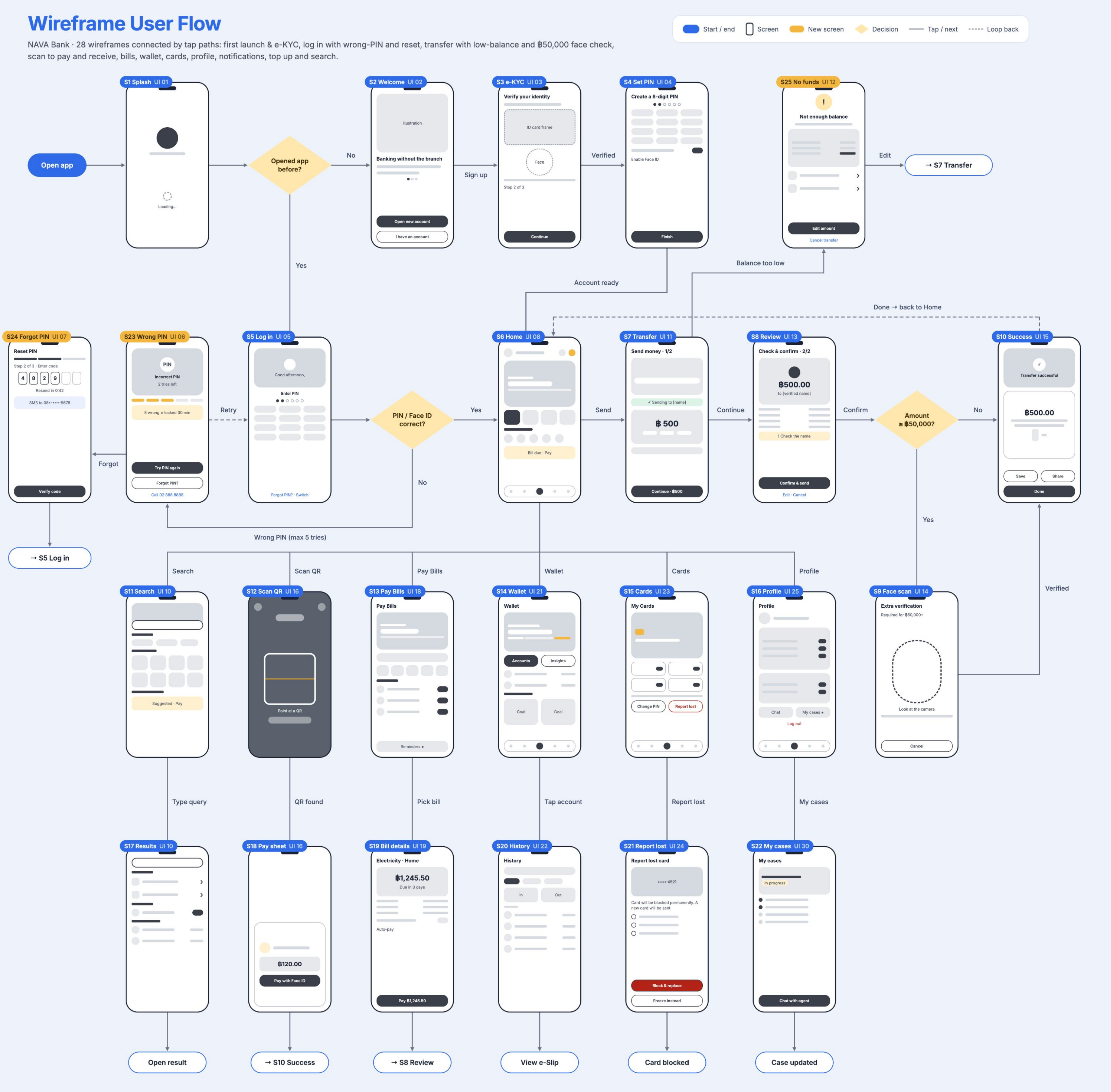
Bank of Thailand rule: transfers of ฿50,000 or more per transaction need face verification.

Risk signals: account opened recently, reported by other customers, or the user is on a phone call while sending.

Screens in this flow: UI 05 Log in · 06 Wrong PIN · 07 Forgot PIN · 08 Home · 11 Send money · 12 Insufficient funds · 13 Review · 14 Face verification · 15 Success · 16 Scan QR · 28 Scam alert

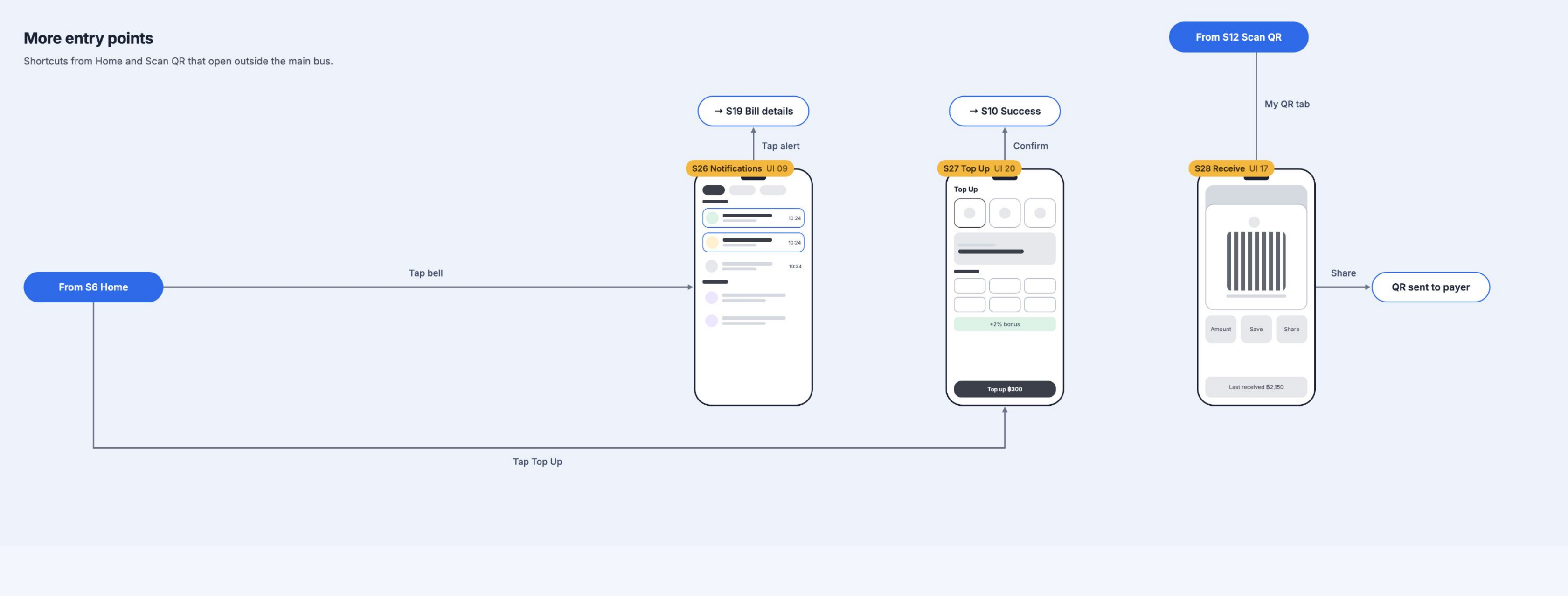
Wireframe User Flow

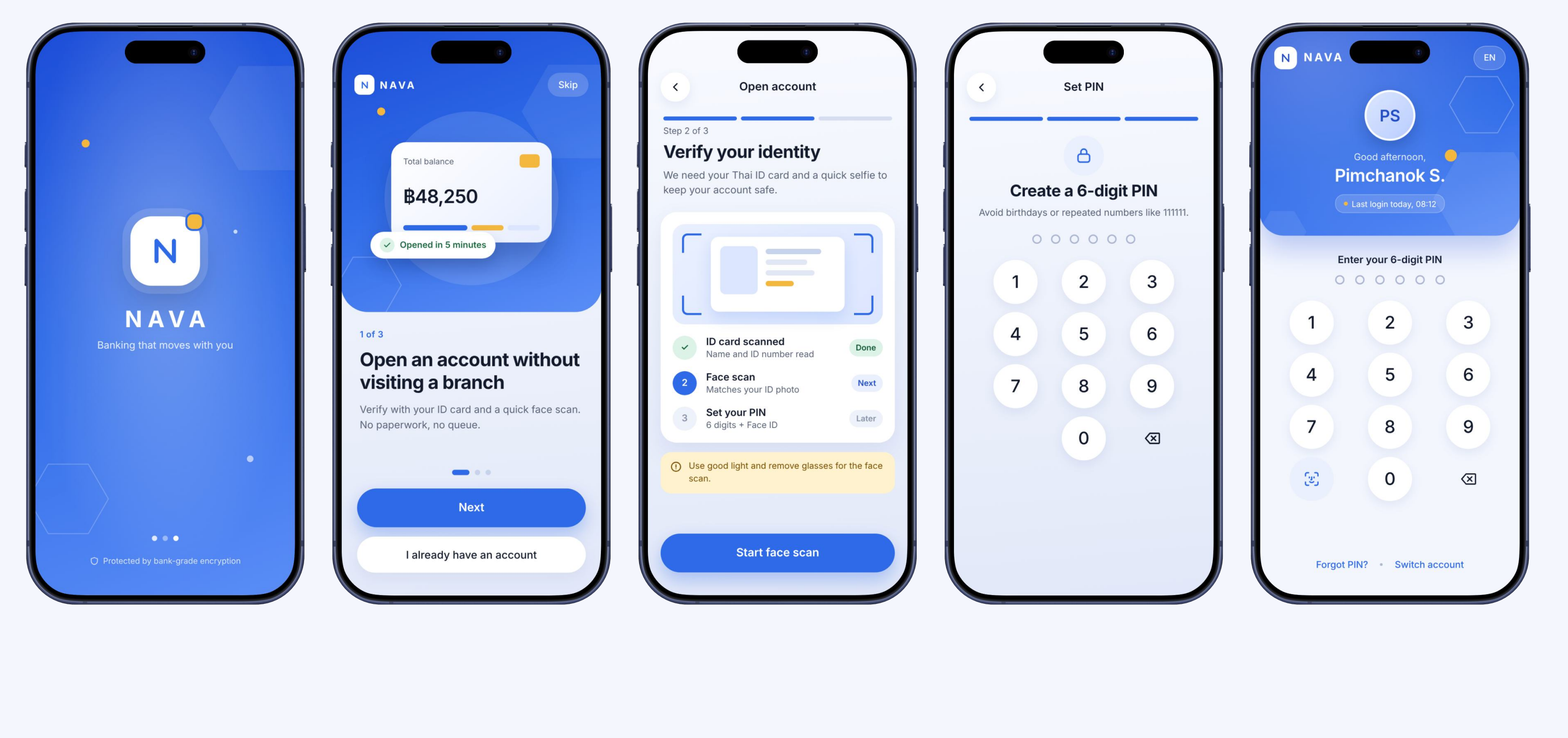
NAVA Bank · 28 wireframes connected by tap paths: first launch & e-KYC, log in with wrong-PIN and reset, transfer with low-balance and ฿50,000 face check, scan to pay and receive, bills, wallet, cards, profile, notifications, top up and search.



More entry points

Shortcuts from Home and Scan QR that open outside the main bus.





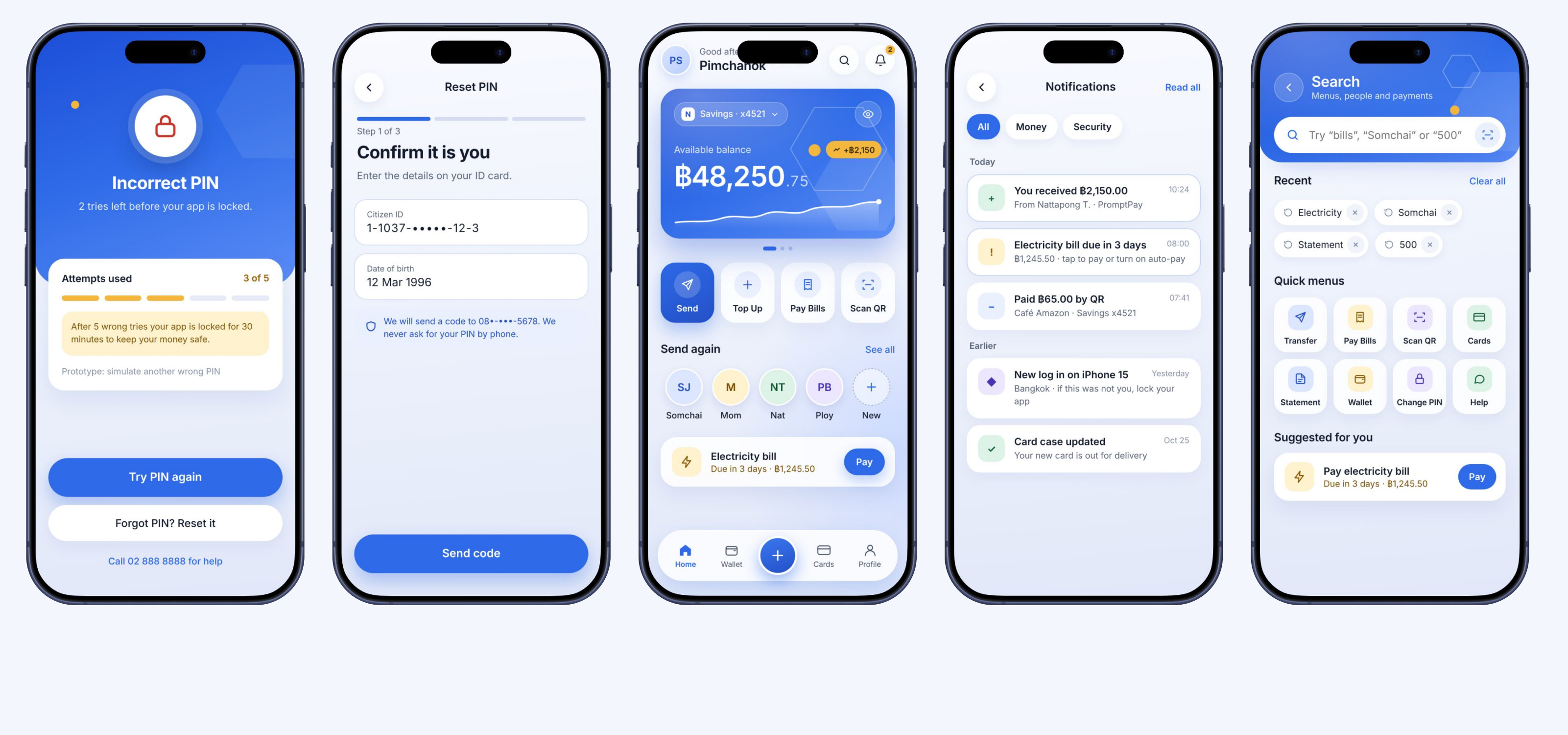
Verify with your ID card and a quick face scan. No paperwork, no queue.

We need your Thai ID card and a quick selfie to keep your account safe.

Name and ID number read · Matches your ID photo · 6 digits + Face ID

Use good light and remove glasses for the face scan.

Avoid birthdays or repeated numbers like 111111.



2 tries left before your app is locked.

After 5 wrong tries your app is locked for 30 minutes to keep your money safe.

Prototype: simulate another wrong PIN

Enter the details on your ID card.

Citizen ID: 1-1037-•••••-12-3

Date of birth: 12 Mar 1996

We will send a code to 08•-•••-5678. We never ask for your PIN by phone.

You received ฿2,150.00 · From Nattapong T. · PromptPay · 10:24

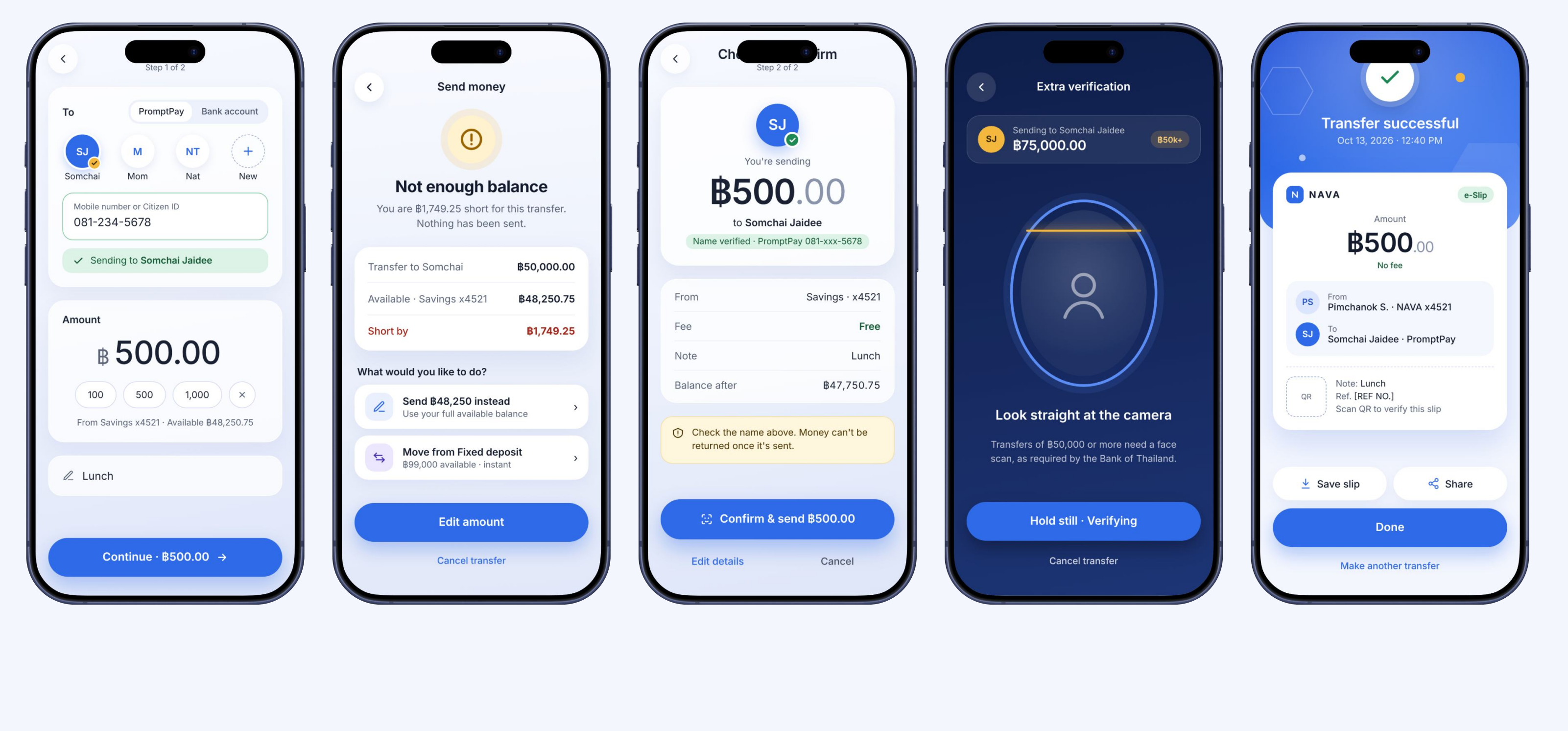
Electricity bill due in 3 days · ฿1,245.50 · tap to pay or turn on auto-pay · 08:00

Paid ฿65.00 by QR · Café Amazon · Savings x4521 · 07:41

New log in on iPhone 15 · Bangkok · if this was not you, lock your app · Yesterday

Card case updated · Your new card is out for delivery · Oct 25

Try "bills", "Somchai" or "500"



Mobile number or Citizen ID: 081-234-5678

✓ Sending to Somchai Jaidee

฿ 500.00

From Savings x4521 · Available ฿48,250.75

Lunch

You are ฿1,749.25 short for this transfer. Nothing has been sent.

Transfer to Somchai	฿50,000.00
Available · Savings x4521	฿48,250.75
Short by	฿1,749.25

Send ฿48,250 instead · Use your full available balance

Move from Fixed deposit · ฿99,000 available · instant

฿500.00 to Somchai Jaidee

Name verified · PromptPay 081-xxx-5678

From	Savings · x4521
Fee	Free
Note	Lunch
Balance after	฿47,750.75

Check the name above. Money can't be returned once it's sent.

Sending to Somchai Jaidee ฿75,000.00

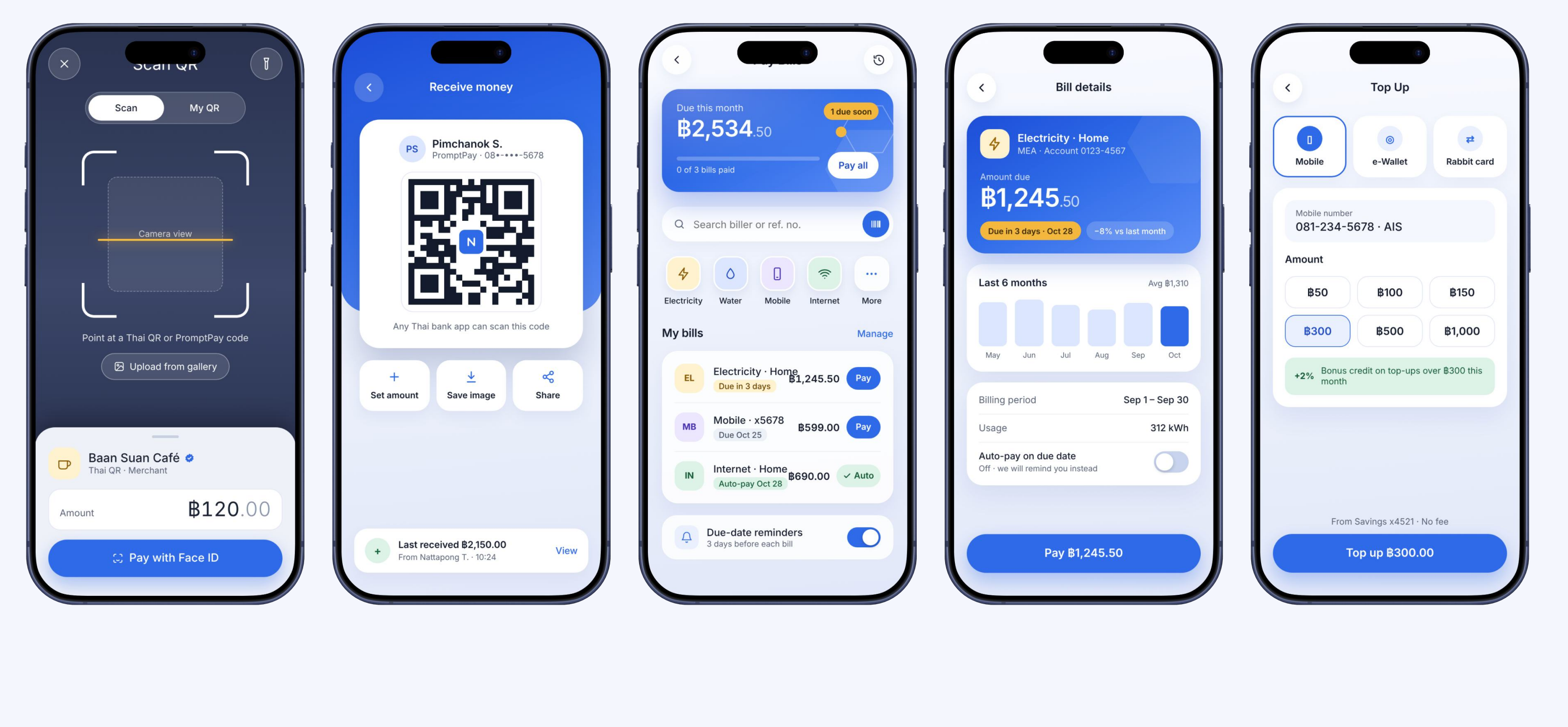
Transfers of ฿50,000 or more need a face scan, as required by the Bank of Thailand.

Amount ฿500.00 · No fee

From Pimchanok S. · NAVA x4521

To Somchai Jaidee · PromptPay

Note: Lunch · Ref. [REF NO.] · Scan QR to verify this slip



Point at a Thai QR or PromptPay code

Baan Suan Café · Thai QR · Merchant · Amount ฿120.00

Pimchanok S. · PromptPay · 08•-•••-5678

Any Thai bank app can scan this code

Last received ฿2,150.00 · From Nattapong T. · 10:24

฿2,534.50 · 0 of 3 bills paid

Search biller or ref. no.

Electricity · Home · Due in 3 days	฿1,245.50	Pay
Mobile · x5678 · Due Oct 25	฿599.00	Pay
Internet · Home · Auto-pay Oct 28	฿690.00	✓ Auto

Due-date reminders · 3 days before each bill

Electricity · Home · MEA · Account 0123-4567

Amount due ฿1,245.50 · Due in 3 days · Oct 28 · −8% vs last month

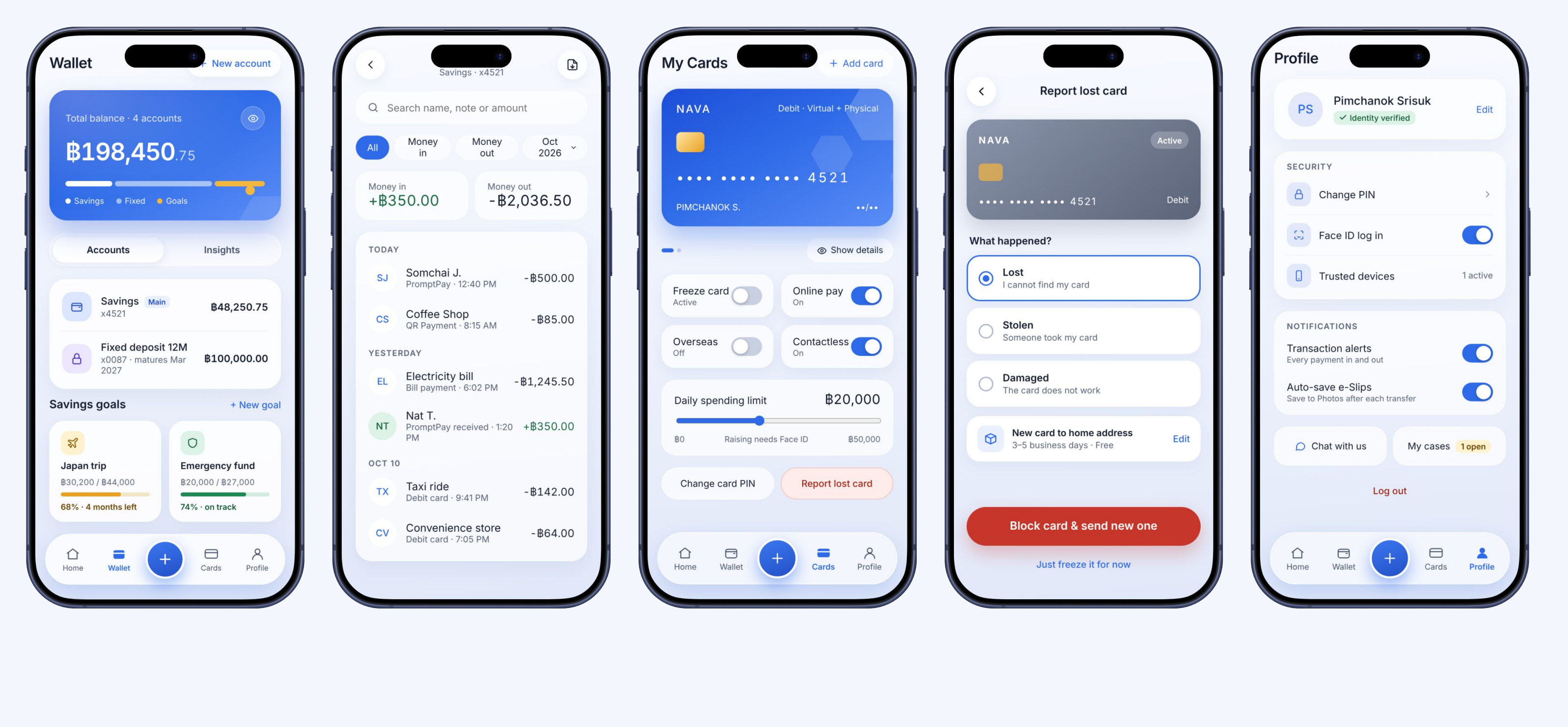
Avg ฿1,310

Billing period	Sep 1 – Sep 30
Usage	312 kWh
Auto-pay on due date	Off · we will remind you instead

Mobile number: 081-234-5678 · AIS

+2% Bonus credit on top-ups over ฿300 this month

From Savings x4521 · No fee



Total balance · 4 accounts ฿198,450.75

Savings Main x4521	฿48,250.75
Fixed deposit 12M x0087 · matures Mar 2027	฿100,000.00

Japan trip · ฿30,200 / ฿44,000 · 68% · 4 months left

Emergency fund · ฿20,000 / ฿27,000 · 74% · on track

Search name, note or amount

Money in +฿350.00 · Money out −฿2,036.50

Somchai J. · PromptPay · 12:40 PM	−฿500.00
Coffee Shop · QR Payment · 8:15 AM	−฿85.00
Electricity bill · Bill payment · 6:02 PM	−฿1,245.50
Nat T. · PromptPay received · 1:20 PM	+฿350.00
Taxi ride · Debit card · 9:41 PM	−฿142.00
Convenience store · Debit card · 7:05 PM	−฿64.00

•••• •••• •••• 4521

Freeze card	Active
Online pay	On
Overseas	Off
Contactless	On

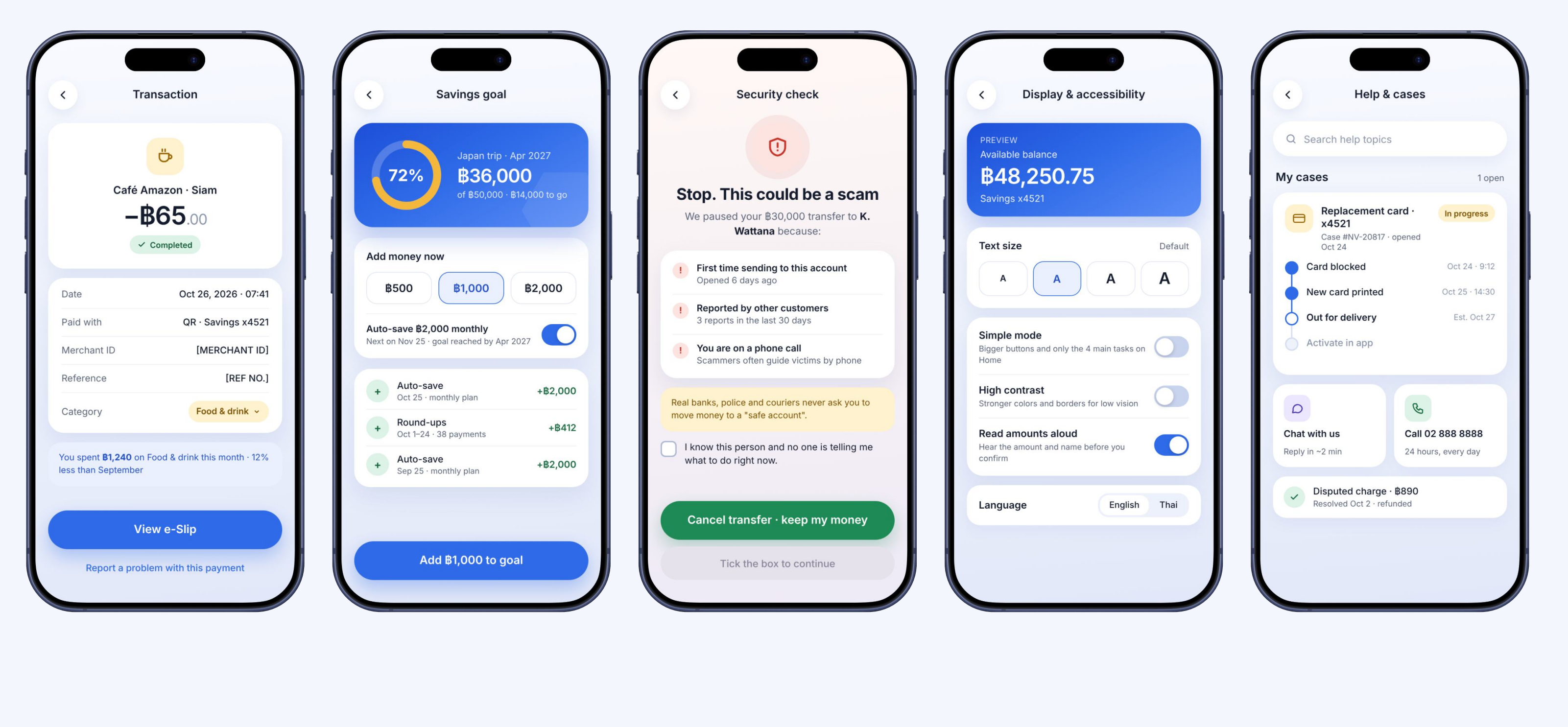
฿0 · Raising needs Face ID · ฿50,000

- Lost · I cannot find my card
- Stolen · Someone took my card
- Damaged · The card does not work

New card to home address · 3–5 business days · Free · Edit

PS Pimchanok Srisuk · ✓ Identity verified

Change PIN	›
Face ID log in	On
Trusted devices	1 active
Transaction alerts · Every payment in and out	On
Auto-save e-Slips · Save to Photos after each transfer	On



Café Amazon · Siam −฿65.00

Date	Oct 26, 2026 · 07:41
Paid with	QR · Savings x4521
Merchant ID	[MERCHANT ID]
Reference	[REF NO.]
Category	Food & drink

You spent ฿1,240 on Food & drink this month · 12% less than September

Japan trip · Apr 2027 ฿36,000 of ฿50,000 · ฿14,000 to go

Auto-save ฿2,000 monthly · Next on Nov 25 · goal reached by Apr 2027

Auto-save	Oct 25 · monthly plan	+฿2,000
Round-ups	Oct 1–24 · 38 payments	+฿412
Auto-save	Sep 25 · monthly plan	+฿2,000

Stop. This could be a scam

We paused your ฿30,000 transfer to K. Wattana because:

- First time sending to this account · Opened 6 days ago
- Reported by other customers · 3 reports in the last 30 days
- You are on a phone call · Scammers often guide victims by phone

Real banks, police and couriers never ask you to move money to a "safe account".

☐ I know this person and no one is telling me what to do right now.

Available balance ฿48,250.75 · Savings x4521

Simple mode · Bigger buttons and only the 4 main tasks on Home	Off
High contrast · Stronger colors and borders for low vision	Off
Read amounts aloud · Hear the amount and name before you confirm	On

Replacement card · x4521 · Case #NV-20817 · opened Oct 24

Card blocked	Oct 24 · 9:12
New card printed	Oct 25 · 14:30
Out for delivery	Est. Oct 27
Activate in app	

Disputed charge · ฿890 · Resolved Oct 2 · refunded